

# Sentiment Analysis

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Text Processing

Department of Computer Science, University of Sheffield

Autumn Semester 2023

# Text Processing: Overview

- ▶ Introduction [RG]
- ▶ Text encoding [RG]
- ▶ Information Retrieval [RG]
- ▶ Text Compression [RG]

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- ▶ Introduction [RG]
- ▶ Text encoding [RG]
- ▶ Information Retrieval [RG]
- ▶ Text Compression [RG]
  
- ▶ **Sentiment Analysis [CS]**
- ▶ **Information Extraction [CS]**
- ▶ **Introduction to Deep Learning for Text Processing [CS]**

# Text Processing: SA and IE Assessment

## COM3110: 10 Credit module:

- ▶ Assignment 1 [25%]
- ▶ **Assignment 2 [25%]**
- ▶ Exam [50%]

## COM4115: 15 Credit module:

- ▶ Assignment 1 [25%]
- ▶ **Assignment 2 [25%]**
- ▶ Exam [50%]

## Assignment 2:

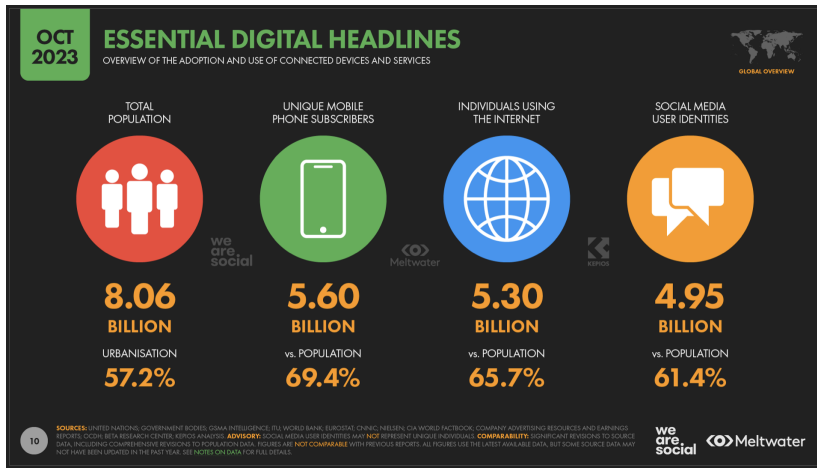
- ▶ Handout on **Friday, 24th November**
- ▶ Deadline: **Friday, 15th December @ 3pm**

# Sentiment Analysis: motivations, definitions and more

# Learning objectives

- ▶ Explain the SA task, including its main concepts and motivations
- ▶ Explain the differences between subjective and factual data
- ▶ Explain and apply the Bing Liu's model for SA
- ▶ Define two granularity levels for SA

# The world is digital!



Source: <https://datareportal.com/global-digital-overview>

# The world is digital!

People express their **emotions**, **sentiments** or **opinions**

- ▶ comments on products (Amazon, Rakuten)
- ▶ comments on movies (Rotten Tomatoes, IMDB, Youtube)
- ▶ experience in restaurants (Yelp!, Trip Advisor)
- ▶ social media (Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, LinkedIn, Reddit, Flickr)



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- ▶ social media (Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, LinkedIn, Reddit, Flickr)
- ▶ **Very large quantity of information**
  - ▶ Not feasible for manual annotation
  - ▶ Companies want business intelligence!

# General goal of SA

Extract **emotions**, **sentiments** or **opinions**

- ▶ Expressed by humans in **texts**
- ▶ Use that information for business or intelligence purposes

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Answer questions like:

- ▶ Do people liked this movie?
- ▶ Do people agree with this law?
- ▶ Customers: should you buy this washing machine?
- ▶ Prediction: who will win next election?

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Sentiment analysis  $\approx$  opinion mining

- ▶ considered as equivalent in our case...
- ▶ ...although a sentiment does not necessarily express an opinion!

# Importance of SA

## To make decisions!

- ▶ **Politics:** can replace surveys, polls, etc.
- ▶ **Market:** complete/verify/correct vendor's advice
- ▶ **Television:** decide whether to continue or stop a TV show
- ▶ **Individuals:** decide whether to buy a product or not / decide whether to vote for a politician or not / etc

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Because

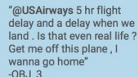
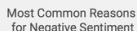
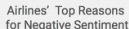
- ▶ people express themselves on the web on any subject
- ▶ provides an estimate of the global opinion
- ▶ can be done at large scale



## Analysis of traveler's Tweets from a week in February 2015



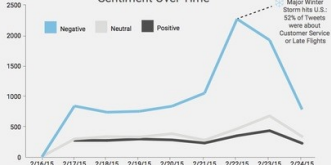
### Sentiment by Airline



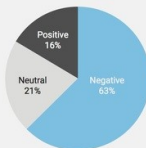
"@USAirways of course never again tho. Thanks for tweetin ur concern but not Doin anythin to fix what happened. I'll choose wiser next time"  
-OBJ\_3



### Sentiment Over Time



### Sentiment Breakdown



### Most Common Words from Negative Tweets



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# An example + concepts

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@JetBlue , I normally ❤️ you , but this Late Flight flight experience was the worst . 2 hours on runway, no wifi & tv not working properly



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▶ "❤️ you" is a positive **opinion**

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- ▶ "❤️ you" is a positive **opinion**
- ▶ "I normally ❤️ you" is a less **positive opinion**

# An example + concepts

## An example

@JetBlue , I normally  you , but this Late Flight flight experience **was the worst** . 2 hours on runway, no wifi & tv not working properly

- ▶ " you" is a positive **opinion**
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- ▶ "was the worst." is a **negative opinion**

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- ▶ "@JetBlue" and "Late Flight flight experience": the **target of opinions**
- ▶ "2 hours on runway, no wifi & tv not working properly" is the **objective** part
- ▶ "I" is the **holder of opinion**

# Target of opinions

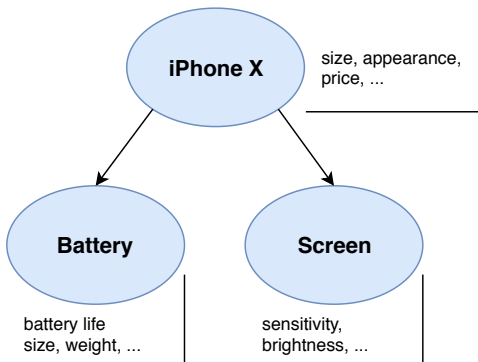
A **person**, **event**, **organisation**, or **topic**

- ▶ Represented as a hierarchy of **components** having a set of **attributes**
  - ▶ let's call them both **features**
- ▶ An **opinion** is expressed about any **feature**

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# Factuality vs. Subjectivity

# Factual vs. subjective data

## Facts

**something that is known to have happened or to exist, for which proof or information exists**

- ▶ can be expressed using **keywords**
- ▶ less/not subject to interpretation
- ▶ might be difficult to identify though!

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**something that is known to have happened or to exist, for which proof or information exists**

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## Opinions / subjective data

**a thought, belief, judgment about something or someone**

- ▶ no proof required
- ▶ can be hard to express with keywords

# Factual vs. subjective data: examples

## What do people think of

1. *@SouthwestAir just did, thank you*

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5. *It costed 500 dollars.*



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4. *@united worst service ever 😈*
5. *It costed 500 dollars.*
6. *It costed 500 dollars!!!*

# Subjectivity analysis

**Subjectivity classification** is often the first step for sentiment analysis.

Aims: decide whether a text is **objective** or **subjective**

- ▶ **objective**: It costed 500 dollars.
- ▶ **subjective**: this Late Flight flight experience was the worst.

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Aims: decide whether a text is **objective** or **subjective**

- ▶ **objective**: It costed 500 dollars.
- ▶ **subjective**: this Late Flight flight experience was the worst.

However, it is not always as simple as that...

- ▶ **objective** sentences can express opinion **indirectly**:
  - ▶ *My phone broke in the second day.*
- ▶ **subjective** sentences **do not always** express positive or negative opinions:
  - ▶ *I think they will refund us.*

## Bing Liu's model for SA

# Bing Liu's model for Sentiment Analysis

An **opinion** is a quintuple  $(o_j, f_{jk}, so_{ijkl}, h_i, t_l)$ , where:

- ▶  $o_j$  is the targeted **object** of opinion. Also called **entity**.
- ▶  $f_{jk}$  is a **feature** of the object  $o_j$ . Also called **aspect**.
- ▶  $so_{ijkl}$  is the **sentiment value**
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- ▶ 1 to 5 stars, as in movie reviews
- ▶ more granular ratings (“slider”)





## Example

On 25th Oct. 2018 , John Doe wrote:

“ I bought the new iPhone a few days ago. It was such a nice phone . The touch screen was really cool . The voice quality was clear too. Although the battery life is not long , that is ok for me. However, my mother was mad with me as I did not tell her before I bought the phone. She also thought the phone was too expensive , and wanted me to return it to the shop.”

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- ▶  $o_j$ : iPhone
- ▶  $f_{jk}$ : phone, touch screen, voice quality, battery life, price
- ▶  $so_{ijkl}$ : **positive**, **positive**, **positive**, **negative**, **negative**
- ▶ opinion holder  $h_i$ : I, I, I, I, mother
- ▶ time  $t_I$ : 25/10/2018

# Sentiment Analysis

## Opinion mining

- ▶ Discover all quintuples  $(o_j, f_{jk}, so_{ijkl}, h_i, t_l)$  in a document

## Structure the unstructured

- ▶ Use in data visualisation tools
- ▶ **Quantitative** and **qualitative** analysis
- ▶ To answer questions like:
  - ▶ Do people like the new iPhone?
  - ▶ Among them, what are the features that they most dislike?
  - ▶ Among people that don't like the iPhone, what feature is missing?

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- ▶ (iPhone, phone, positive, I, 25/10/2018)
- ▶ (iPhone, touch screen, positive, I, 25/10/2018)
- ▶ (iPhone, voice quality, positive, I, 25/10/2018)
- ▶ (iPhone, battery life, negative, I, 25/10/2018)
- ▶ (iPhone, price, negative, mother, 25/10/2018)



# Sentiment Analysis: not just ONE problem

Discover all quintuples  $(o_j, f_{jk}, so_{ijkl}, h_i, t_l)$  in a document

- ▶  $o_j$  – the target **object** or **entity**:
  - ▶ **Named Entity Recognition**
  - ▶ **Coreference resolution**
- ▶  $f_{jk}$  – a **feature** or **aspect**: **Information Extraction** (more about that later...)
- ▶  $so_{ijkl}$  – **sentiment value**: **Sentiment Identification**
- ▶  $h_i$  – **sentiment holder**: **Information/Data Extraction**
- ▶  $t_l$  – **time**: **Information/Data Extraction**

# Sentiment Analysis: not just ONE problem

Discover all quintuples  $(o_j, f_{jk}, so_{ijkl}, h_i, t_l)$  in a document

- ▶ **Summarising opinions** is often necessary (e.g. Kindle Paperwhite has over 5K reviews)
- ▶ Often reviews talk about **more than one feature**
- ▶ Quintuple extraction can help solve this issue

## SA granularity levels

# Sentiment Analysis granularity → document level

- ▶ Assumption: document focuses on a **single object** from a **single opinion holder**.
- ▶ Goal: discover  $(\_, \_, so, \_, \_)$
- ▶ ignore  $o_j, f_{jk}, h_i, t_l$
- ▶ **Reviews** usually satisfy the assumption
  - ▶ Positive = 4 or 5 ☆, Neutral = 3 ☆, Negative = 1 or 2 ☆

# Sentiment Analysis granularity → sentence level

- ▶ **Sentence** level SA is similar to document level
  - ▶ Assumption: sentence contains a **single opinion** from a **single opinion holder**
  - ▶ Only an **intermediate** step
  - ▶ Consists of two steps:
    1. **Subjectivity** classification → **detect** if the sentence expresses an opinion
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  - ▶ Corpus-based (Naive Bayes)
- 2. **Sentiment** classification
  - ▶ Rule-based
  - ▶ Corpus-based

# Sentiment Analysis granularity → feature level 1/2

## Motivation

- ▶ Document and sentences may contain **mixed** opinions
  - ▶ **Targets** of opinions (**features**) are ignored
  - ▶ SA at this level provides a **general** opinion on the **object**
  - ▶ Does not mean that **opinion holder** likes/dislikes everything about it.
- 
- ▶ **Feature** level aims to provide a more fine-grained analysis
    - ▶ **which** component people like/dislike
    - ▶ more informative analysis
    - ▶ consists of 5 steps



# Sentiment Analysis granularity → feature level 2/2

## 1. Identify **entities** or **objects**

- ▶ Given a set  $Q$  of **seed entities** of class  $C$ , and a set  $D$  of **candidate entities**, determine which of the entities in  $D$  belong to  $C$ .
- ▶ binary classification problem

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  - ▶ Challenge: infrequent feature extraction

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  - ▶ detailed later
5. [optional] Produce a summary of all feature-based opinions

# Learning objectives

- ▶ Explain the SA task, including its main concepts and motivations
- ▶ Explain the differences between subjective and factual data
- ▶ Explain and apply the Bing Liu's model for SA
- ▶ Define two granularity levels for SA

# Reading material

- ▶ Bing Liu and Lei Zhang (2012). A survey on opinion mining and sentiment analysis. Kluwer Academic Publishers:  
[http://www.cs.uic.edu/~lzhang3/paper/opinion\\_survey.pdf](http://www.cs.uic.edu/~lzhang3/paper/opinion_survey.pdf)
- ▶ Bing Liu (2010). Sentiment Analysis and Subjectivity. Handbook of Natural Language Processing, Second Edition, (editors: N. Indurkha and F. J. Damerau):  
<https://www.cs.uic.edu/~liub/FBS/NLP-handbook-sentiment-analysis.pdf>

Credits: slides based on Loïc Barrault's slides for the autumn 2020/2021 COM3110/COM4115 course and Bing Liu's slides for AAAI 2011/EACL 2012 tutorials.



# References I

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Mining and summarizing customer reviews.

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